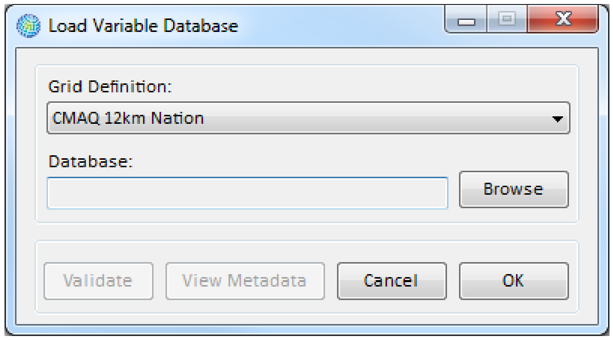
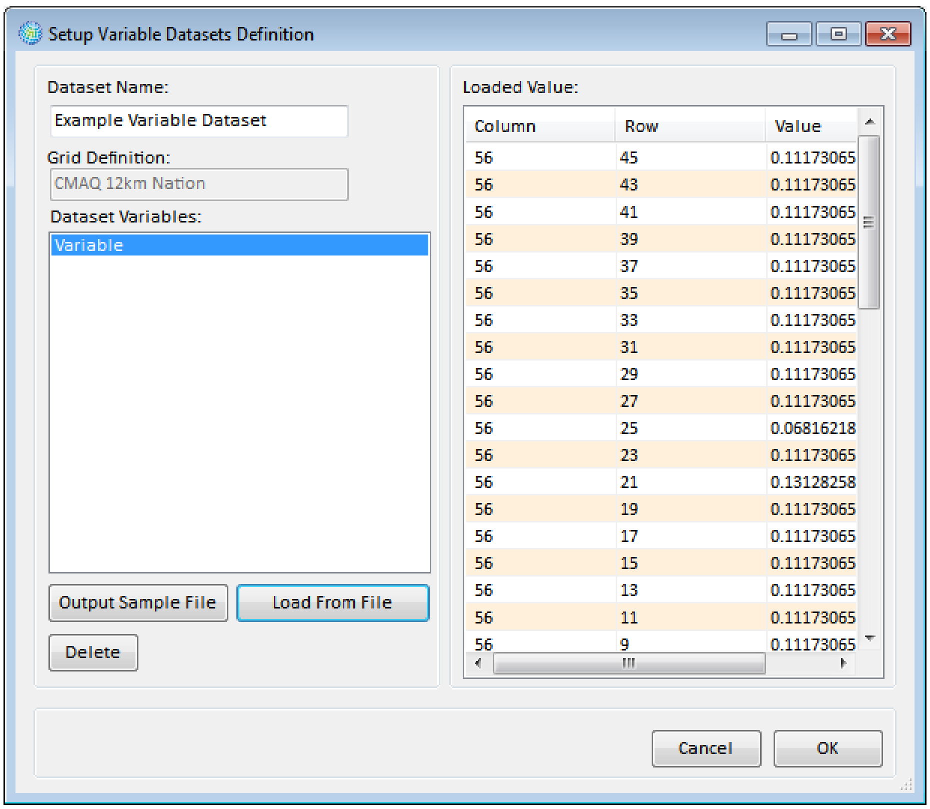
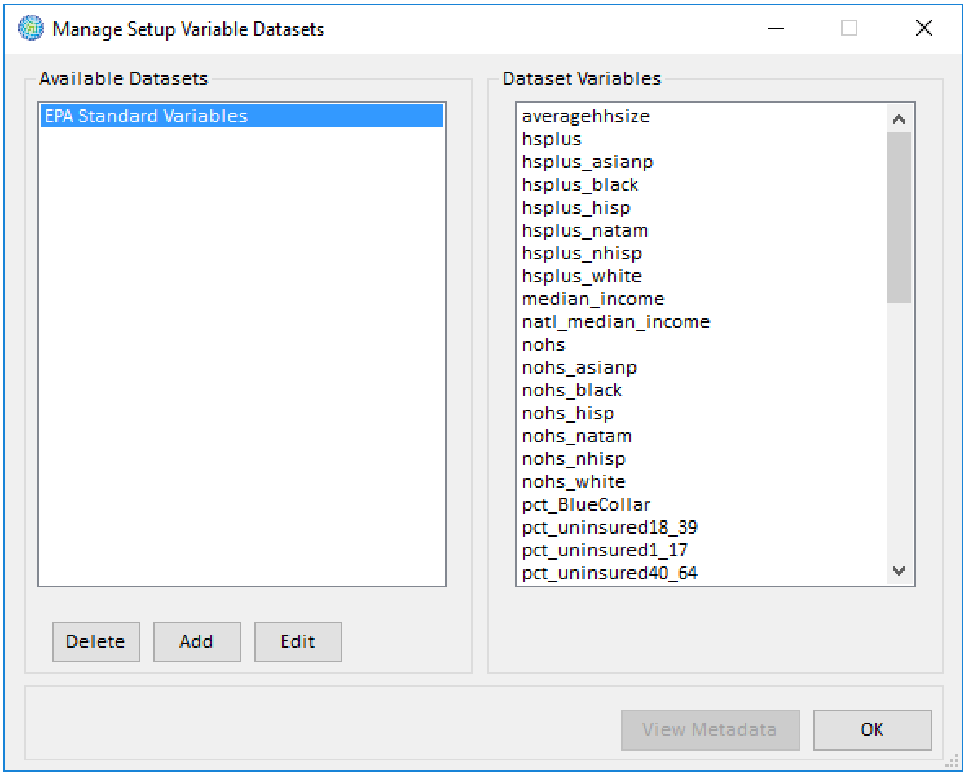


After choosing (and validating) the input file, click **OK**. This takes you back to the **Setup Variable Datasets Definition** window. This window displays the variables in the dataset and their values.



When finished adding variables, click **OK.** This will take you to the **Manage Setup Variable Datasets** window.

In the **Available Datasets** list box there is an entry for the dataset that you just added. And in the **Dataset Variables** list box are the variables in the highlighted dataset.



At this point you may click **Add** to load an additional dataset, click **Edit** to edit the selected dataset, click **Delete** to delete the selected dataset, or complete this variable management step by clicking **OK**.

Clicking **OK** returns you to the **Modify Datasets** window, where the entry for the variable dataset that you just entered should be visible under the **Variable Datasets** box.

4.1.7.2 Format for Variable Data

Table 4-12a presents the variables that can be used in variable datasets, and Table 4-12b presents a sample of what a dataset might look like. Note that if you are loading your own variable data, you can choose your own variable names (July 2018: this feature is currently disabled. Users should currently specify one variable per file).

Table 4-12a. Variable Dataset Variables

Variable	Type	Required	Notes
Column	Integer	Yes	The column and the row link the population data with cells in a Grid Definition.
Row	Integer	Yes	
Median_Income	Numeric (double)	Yes	Example: Median income value.
<Variable Name>	Numeric (double)	No	Additional variables may be specified.

Table 4-12b. Sample Variable Dataset

Column	Row	Median_Income
42	17	39871.19
42	29	43760.31
42	45	38186.77
42	91	42298.49
42	101	31261.07

4.1.8 Inflation Data

It may be desirable for the economic values generated by **Valuation Functions** to account for inflation and generate economic benefits using currency for years other than the year initially specified by your valuation data. To do this, you can load **Inflation Datasets** into BenMAP-CE, and then include a reference to your inflation data when developing valuation functions. (We give an example of this below.)

> **Fundamental Concept – Inflation Dataset**
>
> **Inflation Datasets** allow BenMAP-CE to account for changes in prices over time when presenting valuation estimates for health benefits. This dataset allows the user to specify valuation results in a currency year different from that reported in the valuation function applied. For example, you might use valuation data specified in 2015 dollars yet want to report the BenMAP-CE valuation estimate in 2020 dollars to compare to a cost analysis reporting costs in 2020 dollars. The inflation indices in this table are used to automatically convert currency to the dollar year the user selects when performing an analysis.

The **Valuation Functions** should have a consistent currency year, and this currency year has to be kept in mind when developing the inflation datasets. That is, whichever currency year is used for your valuation functions, then the inflation values for that year should be set to 1. For example, in the *United States* setup, the valuation functions have a dollar year of 2015, so the inflation datasets have a value of 1 for the year 2015. (Values for years earlier than 2015 are less than 1, and values for years after 2015 are greater than 1, because inflation has increased from one year to the next.) The *United States* setup in BenMAP-CE provides inflation factors for three different types of values:

- **All Goods Index** can be used to adjust the value of generic goods.
- **Medical Cost Index** can be used to adjust the value of medical expenses.
- **Wage Index** can be used to adjust the value of wages.

If a **Valuation Function** includes an estimate of wage income, for example, this value could be multiplied by the **Wage Index** adjustment factor to get the specified currency year. For example, in valuing work loss days, the *United States* setup uses a function like the following: *DailyWage*WageIndex*, where the *DailyWage* is specified in year 2015 dollars. In the **Inflation Dataset**, the **WageIndex** scales this **DailyWage** value up or down depending on the currency **Year** you have chosen. If the currency **Year** is 2015, then the **WageIndex** has a value of 1 and no change is made to the **DailyWage**. If the currency **Year** is specified to, say, 2020, then the **WageIndex** will have a value greater than 1 because of the inflation that has occurred between 2015 and 2020.

4.1.8.1. Add Inflation Data

To add inflation data to BenMAP-CE, click on the **Manage** button below the **Inflation Datasets** box in the **Modify Datasets** window. The **Manage Inflation Datasets** window will appear. In this window you may **Add**, **Edit**, and **Delete** datasets. The section on the left under **Available Datasets** lists the **Inflation Datasets** that are currently in the setup database. The section on the right under **Inflation Detail** presents the inflation factors in a selected dataset.

Click on the **Add** button. In **the Load Inflation Dataset** window, type in the name of the dataset in the **Inflation Dataset Name** box, and then click on the **Browse** button to the right of the **Database** box to choose the dataset that you want to import and click **Open**. You can click the **Validate** button to ensure the file is properly formatted before importing. BenMAP-CE's validation tool will review the file format (column names, required columns, and data types) and provide a report with any errors or warnings. In addition, you can add metadata to the file, to include references and descriptions, by clicking the **View Metadata** button. Click **OK**. The **Manage Inflation Datasets** window will appear. Here you may view the data that you just loaded.